

THE STRUCTURE OF MATHEMATICAL REALITY

Phase IV — Chapter 13

Measurement: How the World Gets Numbers

Parallel Reading

Self-Study Curriculum

Parallel Reading: S. S. Stevens, “On the Theory of Scales of Measurement” (*Science*, 1946, approximately 4 pages, freely available online): the founding paper; it introduces the nominal / ordinal / interval / ratio hierarchy. Short enough to read twice, and you should.

Also read: Paul Velleman & Leland Wilkinson, “Nominal, Ordinal, Interval, and Ratio Typologies Are Misleading” (*The American Statistician*, 1993, approximately 8 pages): the essential corrective, so you do not take Stevens as a rulebook. (**Core reading $\approx$ 12 pages.**)